



Incident report analysis

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to practice applying the NIST framework to different situations you encounter.

Summary	
Identify	Our security audit recognizes the unconfigured firewall as a massive security risk. This allowed a flood of ICMP packets to overload and crash our internal network completely halting access to our network servers for approximately 2 hours. Going forward from here we need to perform quarterly internal network assessments, audit firewall configurations, and to verify access controls to identify vulnerabilities that can be spotted before they are exploited.
Protect	To protect our network from DDOS attacks in the future we have implemented a rate limit for ICMP traffic and enabled IP source verification to stop spoofed IP's from getting through. We'll also update the firewall configuration policy to require peer review before deployment, and provide training for IT staff on secure firewall configurations.
Detect	We've installed network monitoring software and an IDS/IPS solution to detect unusual spikes in ICMP traffic. Alerts will trigger when traffic exceeds thresholds or patterns indicate a potential DDoS event. Continuous tuning of the IDS rules will ensure effectiveness against new

	threats.
Respond	During the incident, we quickly blocked ICMP traffic and shut down non-critical services to preserve bandwidth. Moving forward, we're developing an incident response playbook specifically for DDoS attacks, which will include predefined response steps, communication templates, and responsibilities.
Recover	Critical network services were restored within two hours. Recovery efforts are now being documented, and we're evaluating cloud-based DDoS mitigation services to reduce downtime in future events. Post-incident reviews will be conducted after every event to drive ongoing improvements.

Reflections/Notes: As an organization, we recently experienced a DDOS attack that compromised our system for two hours. This time we were flooded with ICMP packets that caused our network services to stop responding. The internal network traffic could not access any network resources. Our incident management team blocked all incoming ICMP packets and restored our critical network services. This all occurred due to an entry point in a firewall that increased our attack surface.

To be secured:

- We need to reconfigure the firewall that was accessed to ensure that our attack surface is minimized.
- We also need to configure an IDS/IPS to focus on filtering ICMP packets or massive spikes in traffic on our network
- Need to enable a firewall rule that limits the amount of ICMP traffic allowed to further DDOS attacks.